

MORPHOLOGY & SPELLING

Upper Elementary | Unit 5

Keep the Base Word



Today I am learning when a base word **keeps its spelling** when I add a suffix.

1 Learn the Rule

Sometimes you can add a suffix and keep **every letter** in the base word. If no spelling-change rule is needed, keep the base word unchanged.

help + ful = helpful kind + ness = kindness
quick + ly = quickly care + less = careless

2 Build the Word

Add the suffix without changing the spelling of the base word.

Base word	Add suffix	New word	What changed?
help	-ful	_____	_____
kind	-ness	_____	_____
quick	-ly	_____	_____
care	-less	_____	_____
read	-er	_____	_____

3 Read and Notice

Read the passage below.

Noah was a **helpful** member of the school garden group. He arrived **quickly** when the team needed extra hands and treated everyone with **kindness**. His job was to refill the watering cans and check the seed labels. A younger **reader** asked him what one sign meant, so Noah explained it **carefully**. The group was **thankful** for his help because the garden had become a **peaceful** place to work. Later, Noah noticed a **careless** mistake on one label and fixed it before anyone planted the wrong seeds. At the end of the morning, the leader praised his **thoughtful** choices. Noah was proud that simple actions, done **kindly** and **quickly**, had made the job easier for everyone.



Find and highlight words where the **base word** stayed unchanged.

4 Word Detective

Choose one derived word from the passage and investigate how it was built.

- Write one derived word from the passage.

- What is its base word?

- Which suffix was added?

- Show the word sum: base + suffix -> new word.

5 Sort the Words

Sort the words into the correct group.

helpful kindness quickly making running happier

Base stayed the same

Base changed first

6 Use It in Writing



Complete the sentence starters.

- I was _____ when _____.

- Use another word with an **unchanged base** in a sentence.



Parent check

Tick the skills your learner has demonstrated.

- ☐ Spots when the base stays unchanged
- ☐ Identifies the base word and suffix
- ☐ Builds derived words accurately
- ☐ Explains when no spelling change is needed



Capture idea:

Find a suffixed word in a book or around the home. Write its **base + suffix**. Did the base stay the same?